

Level 4 Preparation - The Front Desk

Document: Level 4 Preparation - The Front Desk
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Chain: n/a
Tx: [not anchored]
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Prepare before the 90-minute meeting. Each learner needs their own Ollama-capable computer. Reuse the course fork, Python environment, and Ollama from Levels 1-3. A phone can read the packet but does not replace the prepared computer. Saved examples support an outage; they do not prove that a phone ran the lab.

Tools and downloads

Use the [course repository](#), [Ollama download](#), and [Gemma 3 library page](#). See [Mac setup](#) or [Windows setup](#) if starting fresh. Use the instructor's reviewed course candidate: unpublished local changes are not yet available from the public main branch.

No new API key, subscription, cloud model, or hosting account is needed. Use local gemma3:4b for both phases. Download size and runtime vary; check the model page and Level 3 preparation. Do not start a large download during class. If the computer cannot complete a set in its class block, use the saved packet.

From the course folder

Open the cloned course folder in GitHub Desktop, then open its terminal. Run one line at a time; these commands work on the prepared Mac and Windows routes.

```
uv sync --frozen
ollama pull gemma3:4b
uv run --frozen zta prepare front-desk
uv run --frozen zta doctor front-desk
uv run --frozen zta test front-desk
uv run --frozen zta start front-desk
```

Pull downloads only if needed; do it during preparation. Open [the local desk](#). The terminal stays open. Doctor should name the local model and digest; it does not generate an answer. Tests use fake responses; the five callers check real generation. Stop the browser server with Ctrl+C.

Prepare creates only the private Level 4 instructions, worksheet, and control file. It preserves existing edits, receipts, and phase. Data stays in ignored `.zta/front-desk/`. The desk does not read the Level 1 provider configuration or keys, does not upload files, and does not fall back to a cloud model.

Readiness check

Open the desk and the [caller card](#). Run Five callers before class; confirm replies and a saved run. Keep the receipt as preparation evidence. The first source rule is weak on purpose. A refusal, missing citation, or honest model error is useful evidence, not a reason to invent a pass.

If Ollama is missing, open its app and rerun doctor. If a model is missing, run the supplied pull command during preparation. After two attempts or five minutes, switch to the [saved callers](#) and [saved attacks](#). Keep earlier failed receipts.

Pause and recovery

Click Pause desk when idle. During a run, open a second terminal in this same course folder and run `uv run --frozen zta pause front-desk`. Run a set while paused: its new receipt must say paused and have zero rows. Resume with `uv run --frozen zta resume front-desk`. A request already sent may finish computing; the program withholds that reply and sends no next request. Ctrl+C ends the current terminal process, while the pause setting survives a restart.

Only one run can use a desk folder at a time. If the process crashed and a new run reports it is still active, first close every Front Desk terminal and tab. Keep all run receipts. Then remove only `.zta/front-desk/running.lock` in the file manager. Ask the instructor if unsure. Never delete the whole private folder to clear an error.

Lock is one-way for this lesson. It prevents accidentally adding the bait again. If you locked before saving Before, keep that fact and use the labeled saved Before set; do not rewrite a receipt. Review the frozen prompts and model digest before claiming a matched comparison.